

EDUCATION

Cabinet of the Secretary of State for Education

Legislative order no. 5908/2017

The 21st Constitutional Government recognises education as a privileged means of fostering social justice and equal opportunities, being one of the principles that shape its policy to promote a quality and successful education for all students throughout the 12 years of compulsory schooling.

Promoting a quality education implies ensuring that school achievement means effective and meaningful learning, with consolidated knowledge to be mobilised in concrete situations that foster the development of high level competences, which, in turn, contribute to a successful citizenship within the context of the challenges posed by contemporary society. The set of competences outlined in the *Students' Profile by the End of Compulsory Schooling* and that have been presented in Portugal as well as in the most varied international forums embodies transversal, transdisciplinary competences in a web that interrelates and mobilises a solid combination of knowledge, skills, attitudes and values. The successful citizen is informed, but he is also able to integrate knowledge, solve problems, master different scientific and technical languages, he cooperates, he is autonomous, he has aesthetic and artistic sensitivity and takes care of his well-being.

The implementation of the competence profile that has just been mentioned implies intentionality and educational action leading to the development of the planned areas. As such, being aware that pedagogic differentiation is one of the main tools to guarantee better learning, it is critical that schools are provided with the necessary conditions that allow them to manage the curriculum in order to integrate strategies so as to promote better learning within specific contexts to meet the needs of different students.

To fulfil this *goal* of promoting better learning leading to the development of higher-level competences, the Program of the Government comprises guidelines for the implementation of an educational policy that, assuming the centrality of schools, of their students and teachers, enables a flexible and contextualised management of the curriculum, acknowledging that the effective exercise of autonomy in education is only fully guaranteed if the object of such autonomy is the curriculum.

Traditionally, the tools for school autonomy do not include the core action area of schools, that is, the autonomy within curriculum development.

To provide schools with the opportunity to participate in curriculum development, establishing priorities within the contextualised appropriation of the curriculum and assuming diversity by finding the options that best respond to the challenges of their educational project, is to sustain education in the combination of three fundamental elements: autonomy, trust and responsibility - autonomy based on trust in each school, while being self-aware of its reality and of the responsibility of providing a public service on behalf of a quality education.

Within this framework, and as a result of a long process of consulting various actors at national and international level, with special focus on the Portuguese participation in the OECD *Future of Education 2030* project, as well as for the Students' Voice initiative, the design of a twenty-first century curriculum, the freedom of action to ensure a better learning for all and respect for the autonomy of institutions and their professionals, must necessarily create the conditions that enable Portuguese schools to provide a quality response to these new challenges. The change is therefore not the desire to innovate, it is rather motivated by the appreciation of schools and teachers as agents of curriculum development, ensuring by means of flexibility and autonomy that a deeper learning is achieved by all students.

Consequently, this Legislative Order enshrines the possibility for schools to voluntarily join the Project for Autonomy and Curriculum Flexibility, which defines the principles and guidelines of the design, implementation and evaluation of the primary and secondary education curriculum. This project is implemented on a pedagogical experience basis, allowing monitoring and evaluation, which are critical to its redevelopment. Thus, the real knowledge of its implementation will support the process of reviewing the legal framework, with a view to its generalisation yet assuring its gradual implementation.

Accordingly, pursuant to Articles 3, 4 and 8 of Decree-Law no. 75/2008, of April 22, in the wording given by Decree-Law no. 137/2012, of 2 of July, and under the provisions of Decree-Law no. 47587 of March 10, 1967, and in the use of the powers delegated to me by Order No. 1009-B / 2016, of January 13, published in the *Diário da República*, 2nd series, no. 13, of January 20, 2016, the following is determined:

- 1- -In the scope of the priorities set out by the Program of the 21st Constitutional Government for the area of education, the implementation of the Project for Autonomy and Curriculum Flexibility for primary and secondary education is authorised on a pedagogical experience basis for the school year 2017-2018.
- 2 - For the purposes of the previous paragraph, the guiding principles and rules for the design, implementation and evaluation of the curriculum for primary and secondary education are outlined, as set out in the Annex to this order and which form an integral part thereof.
- 3 - The project covers public and private educational institutions whose management, administration and management bodies show interest in implementing it during the school year 2017-2018.
- 4 - The project's beneficiaries are years/grades 1, 5, 7 and 10, as well as year 1 of vocational courses organised in training cycles.
- 5 - The schools that intend to join the project provide information about the classes and, based on it, there is the provision of a sample that comprises the educational and formative offerings whose curriculum matrices are outlined in Tables I to X, in the Annex to this Order.
- 6 - Ensuring the specificity of the courses with their own plans, the sample may also include 10th grade classes of this offer.

7 - The list of public and private schools that join the project is published on the website of the Directorate-General for Education (DGE), in the area focused on the Project for Autonomy and Curriculum Flexibility.

8 - The project monitoring of each school is ensured at central and regional level by teams whose competences are in compliance with those of the various services and bodies of the Ministry of Education, adopting a proximity model, in which different dynamics are used, among them, national and regional meetings, network meetings, distance support, school visits and training.

9 - In order to comply with the provisions of the preceding paragraph, a national coordination team is set up, assisted by a technical support team and regional clusters, as well as by an advisory council made up of recognised experts in the field of education.

10- The National Coordination team is responsible for:

- a) Setting up the procedures that facilitate the work to be developed in schools, aiming to foster collaborative practices among teachers;
- b) Organising and providing training for human resources;
- c) Drawing proposals aimed at improving, consolidating and reviewing the project;
- d) Developing collaboration mechanisms among the schools involved in the project, promoting good practice sharing and networking;
- e) Ensuring the production of a mid-year report on the evolution of the project, informing the member of the Government responsible for education;
- f) Ensuring project monitoring based on quality and impact indicators so as to evaluate their implementation aiming at their widespread application.

11 - The National Coordination team is led by the Directorate-General for Education (DGE), and also comprised of DGEstE (Directorate-General for Schools), IAVE (Institute for Educational Assessment), ANQEP (National Agency for Qualification and Vocational Training) and IGEC (Inspectorate-General for Education and Science).

12 -The technical support team, comprised of DGE members, works collaboratively with the National Coordination team providing assistance also for regional clusters, fostering balanced procedures, communication management, information provision and training management, as well as producing pedagogical resources and guiding documents.

13 - The regional clusters work closely with schools to support and monitor the projects and are made up of elements of the services and bodies referred to in paragraph 11, divided into five geographical areas in line with DGEstE's five decentralised organic units at regional level, in the following terms:

- a) North regional cluster, led by DGEstE;
- b) Centre regional cluster, led by DGEstE;
- c) Lisbon and outskirts regional cluster, led by DGE;
- d) Alentejo regional cluster, led by DGE;

e) Algarve regional cluster, led by ANQEP;

14 - The advisory council is comprised of consultants with advisory functions defining lines of action, producing tools for monitoring processes and results, as well as advising for decision making and supporting the national coordination team, as regards the action upon schools. This advisory council is made up of recognised experts in the field of education and they are outlined below:

- a) Professor Ariana Cosme;
- b) Professor Isabel Valente Pires;
- c) Professor Joaquim Azevedo;
- d) Professor José Matias Alves;
- e) Professor José Verdasca;
- f) Professor Rui Trindade;
- g) Professor Ricardo Rodrigues.

15 - The services and bodies of the Ministry of Education indicate their representatives in the regional clusters to the coordinator of the national team.

16- The mid-term and final evaluation of the project is carried out at national level by the services of Ministry of Education and at international level by the Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development (OECD).

17 - As a result of the monitoring and evaluation of the project, to be carried out in the school year 2017-2018, the possible revision proposals are identified, aiming at a previous reformulation to a widespread implementation of the Project for Autonomy and Curriculum Flexibility to the school network.

18 - The provisions of this order as well as of its Annex in the school year 2017-2018 shall apply to all the classes covered by the project.

19 - In all that is not specially regulated in the present order and its Annex, and insofar as it does not contradict it, one shall apply the regulations in force for the curriculum and evaluation of primary and secondary education.

20 - The references in the Order or in the Annex:

- a) to the governing bodies, administration and management of public education establishments are considered to be made to bodies with equivalent competence in each private school's educational establishment;
- b) to teachers are considered to trainers as well, where applicable.

21 - This Order shall be into force on the day following that of its publication.

CHAPTER I

General provisions

Article 1

Object

The Project for Autonomy and Curriculum Flexibility, based on a pedagogical experience, defines the guiding principles and rules for the design, implementation and evaluation of the curriculum for primary and secondary education, in order to achieve the “Students’ Profile by the End of Compulsory Schooling”.

Article 2

Definitions

- a) “Curriculum for primary and secondary education” means the set of knowledge, skills and attitudes comprised in curriculum reference documents, in particular in the “Core Curriculum Competences”, from which schools define their curriculum choices in order to achieve the set of competences outlined in the “Students’ Profile by the End of Compulsory Schooling”;
- b) “Core Curriculum Competences”, the common set of knowledge to be attained, that is, the contents of structured, indispensable, aligned and meaningful disciplinary knowledge, as well as the skills and attitudes to be developed by all students in each subject or discipline area generally per year of schooling.
- c) “Curriculum reference documents”, the set of documents that embody the knowledge to be acquired, the skills and attitudes to be developed by the students, namely the syllabi, curriculum outcomes, guidelines, professional profiles and references for the National Qualifications Catalogue, as well as the “Core Curriculum Competences” for each subject and/or discipline area, the latter being the core curriculum guidelines for the planning, implementation and assessment of teaching and learning.
- d) “Curriculum matrices” are the set of disciplinary areas and subjects to be taught per cycle of studies and year of schooling or per training cycle (the latter for vocational courses), as well as the expected instruction time for each of them, which supports the development of the curriculum in curriculum planning tools, at school and in the classroom;
- e) “Autonomy and curriculum flexibility” is the possibility provided to schools so as to manage the primary and secondary education curriculum and the organisation of

curriculum matrices based on the subjects, disciplinary areas and their instruction time, based on the possibility of enriching the curriculum with the knowledge, skills and attitudes that contribute to the achievement of the competences provided for in the “Students’ Profile by the End of Compulsory Schooling”.

- f) "Domains of curriculum autonomy", areas of interdisciplinary work and / or cross curriculum alignment, comprised in the curriculum matrix of an educational and training offer, as a result of the local implementation and management of curriculum carried out by each school within the curriculum planning.

Article 3

Guiding principles

The design, implementation and evaluation of the primary and secondary education curriculum, in the scope of the current project, are in line with the following guiding principles:

- a) Fostering the improvement of teaching and learning quality so that all students are able to achieve the Students’ Profile by the End of Compulsory Schooling;
- b) Implementation of an effective exercise of curriculum autonomy, enabling schools to identify effective curriculum options and in line with the specificity of the educational project and the strategic action plan or, in the case of schools in the Priority Intervention Education Territories, the multiannual improvement plan;
- c) Guaranteeing an inclusive school, whose diversity, flexibility, innovation and personalisation meet the students’ heterogeneity, eliminating barriers to access the curriculum and the learning process in line with the Students’ Profile;
- d) Fostering a better alignment of the three cycles of studies/levels of education (primary and lower secondary education) and upper secondary education, assuming an integrated and sequential curriculum management;
- e) Mobilisation of education agents aiming at promoting the school achievement of all students, based on curriculum co-authoring and shared responsibility;
- f) Valuing the management and interdisciplinary cross curriculum teaching through the development of projects that combine the cross curriculum competences for the different subjects, that are planned, implemented and evaluated by the teachers each class or year of schooling/grade;
- g) Contextual flexibility in curriculum management using the methods, approaches and procedures that are most appropriate for all students to achieve the Students’ Profile by the End of Compulsory Schooling;
- h) Valuing the identity of secondary education as a level of education which offers students different school pathways that aim at addressing their vocational interests and allow

the achievement of compulsory schooling, labour market integration and the pursuit of further studies for all;

- i) Designing an integrative curriculum that aggregates all school activities and projects, assuming them as a source of learning and competence development by students;
- j) Assumption of the importance of the transdisciplinary nature of learning, mobilisation of different literacies and multiple theoretical and practical competences, promoting scientific knowledge, intellectual curiosity, critical and interventional spirit, creativity and collaborative work;
- k) Valuing the Portuguese language and culture as vehicles for fostering national identity;
- l) Valuing foreign languages as vehicles for fostering global and multicultural identity and facilitating access to information and technology;
- m) Assumption of arts, science and technology, sport and humanities as structuring components of the curriculum matrix regarding the multiple educational and training offerings;
- n) Promotion of citizenship and development education throughout all compulsory schooling;
- o) Valuing collaborative and interdisciplinary work in the planning, implementation and assessment of learning;
- p) Assessment of learning as an integral part of curriculum management and a tool for teaching and learning;
- q) Fostering the regulatory purpose of external assessment, valuing a timely and rigorous intervention, supported by the information attained from the benchmarking process, in order to overcome difficulties in the different curriculum domains;
- r) Valuing complementarity between internal and external assessment processes of learning;
- s) Acknowledgement of the importance of external assessment and other specific assessment modalities that convene external entities for the purposes of certification and pursuit of studies by the end of primary and secondary education;
- t) Students and parents' involvement in the identification of school curriculum options;
- u) Acknowledging teachers as key agents of curriculum development with a critical role regarding its evaluation, reflection on the options to be taken, their feasibility and suitability to the contexts of each school community;

Chapter 2

Primary and secondary education curriculum

SECTION I

Conception/design

Article 4

Purpose

1 The curriculum aims at ensuring that all students, regardless of their school pathway, achieve the competences defined in the Students' Profile by the End of Compulsory Schooling

2- In order to achieve this purpose, the following principles underlie the design of the curriculum:

a) Access to the curriculum by all students within a framework of equal opportunities, based on the acknowledgement that all have learning and educational development skills;;

b) Consistency and sequentiality of learning;

c) Possibility of a change of direction or reguidance regarding school pathways within the levels of education in which there are different education offerings and pathways;

d) Assumption of the projects and activities developed within the school community as an integral part of the curriculum;

e) Greater curriculum flexibility regarding the secondary education students, through the possibility of choosing subjects aligned according to their interest, building their own school pathway;

f) Curriculum enrichment by means of providing a school complementary offer component through the creation of new subjects in primary and lower secondary education, using the time credit defined in the Order that sets out the rules for the school year organisation;

g) Fostering moments of support for student learning;

h) Offering to all students the curriculum component Citizenship and Development;

i) Offering Portuguese as a Second Language for students with another mother tongue and Portuguese Sign Language for deaf students;

j) Development of programming within the learning of Information and Communication Technologies, with a possibility of beginning the study of programming in lower-primary education.

k) Curriculum Enrichment Activity offer in primary and lower secondary education on a playful, formative and cultural basis.

Article 5

Curriculum matrix

1 - The primary and secondary education curriculum is embodied in the syllabi and is developed in each of the years of schooling, level of education and training cycles, based on curriculum matrices (Tables I to X).

2 - In the curriculum matrices in which the instruction time presents a weekly organisation, this is a reference for each component of the curriculum, subject area and school subject.

3 – Excluded from the previous number is the artistic component within the specialised artistic courses in lower secondary education and the scientific and technical artistic components within the specialised artistic courses in secondary education.

4 - In each school year, the total instruction time for each year of schooling must be guaranteed.

5 - In the vocational courses (upper primary and secondary education) the official instruction time for each training cycle must be guaranteed.

Article 6

Curriculum autonomy

1 - In the scope of curriculum autonomy and flexibility, schools can manage up to 25% of the weekly instruction time registered in the curriculum matrices per year of schooling or, in the case of vocational courses (upper primary and secondary education), the total instruction time for each training cycle.

2 - Taking into account the context of each school, domains of curriculum autonomy or new subjects can be created, regardless of the existence of the disciplinary areas and subjects foreseen in the curriculum matrices.

3 - The new subjects, created by each school within the instruction time for the Complementary Offer, are the ones that present their own curriculum documents and identity.

Article 7

Structure of curriculum matrices for primary and lower-secondary education

1 - The curriculum matrices for primary and lower secondary education illustrated in Tables I to V include:

a) In lower primary education, different disciplinary areas that allow the curriculum alignment in a globalising approach to teaching and learning based on the practice of a generalist teacher, and a specialist teacher to teach English, as well as development of innovative co-operation projects;

b) In upper primary education, different subjects within disciplinary areas, privileging interdisciplinary approaches fostered by the “two subject” organisation of the teachers’ recruitment for this level of education;

c) In lower secondary education, different subjects within disciplinary areas, privileging interdisciplinary approaches.

2 - In upper primary and lower secondary education, within the curriculum matrices there is the possibility of providing a Complementary Offer component, aiming at the creation of new subjects.

3 - The curriculum matrices for specialised artistic courses include a specialised artistic training component embodied in the curriculum specificity of these courses.

4 - The curriculum matrix for vocational courses in upper primary and lower secondary education, illustrated in Table VI, embodies the socio-cultural, scientific, technological and practical training components, the last two critical for the professional qualification provided by the course.

Article 8

Structure of curriculum matrices for upper secondary education

- 1 The curriculum matrices for upper secondary education, illustrated in Tables VII to X, guarantee the universalisation of learning aiming at the construction of students' personal, social and cultural identity.
- 2 - In compliance with the provisions of the preceding paragraph, the curriculum matrices embody a set of common subjects within the following training components:

a) General component, in the mainstream courses and in the specialised artistic courses;

b) Sociocultural component, in vocational courses;

3- The curriculum matrices also embody the following training components:

a)Specific component, in the mainstream courses, which aims at providing consistent scientific training in the scope of the course;

b) Scientific component, in the specialised artistic courses and vocational courses aimed at acquiring and developing a set of learning competences in line with the specificity of each course;

c) Technical Artistic component in the specialised artistic and technological component courses in vocational courses that aim at the acquisition and development of a set of learning, knowledge and basic skills of the course;

d) Practical component in vocational courses, by means of on-job training context.

4 - In mainstream courses and in the specialised artistic courses, the training components identified in the paragraphs above of the previous number may embody supply subjects of complementary offer depending on each educational school project.

5 - The artistic technical components in the specialised artistic courses, technological component in vocational courses also integrate specific forms of on-job learning context, aiming at the acquisition and the development of technical, relational and organisational skills relevant to the intended professional qualification.

Article 9

Tailored school pathway for upper secondary education

1 - Within the development of the provisions of Article 4 (2) (e), upper secondary education students shall be guaranteed the possibility of creating a school pathway of their own in the following terms:

a) In the mainstream courses, students can exchange one of the biannual or annual subjects within the specific training component for eligible subjects from another learning area/course.

b) In the specialised artistic courses, students can exchange one of the subjects within the scientific training component for:

i) an eligible subject within the scientific training component from a vocational course;

ii) an eligible subject within the specific training component from a mainstream course

c) In vocational courses, students can exchange one of the subjects within the scientific training component for:

i) an eligible subject within the scientific training component from a specialised artistic course;

ii) an eligible subject within the specific training component from a mainstream course

2 - Also included in the range of eligible subjects for exchanges are the subjects within the school's disciplinary offer in line with its educational project.

3 - The list of possibilities of subject exchanges aiming at a tailor made school pathway for upper secondary education is published on the internet, on the DGE site in the specific area for the Project for Autonomy and Curriculum Flexibility.

Article 10

Citizenship and Development and ICT

1 - The components of the curriculum Citizenship and Development (CD) and Information and Communication Technologies (ICT) are embodied, as a rule, in the curriculum matrices of all the years grades of primary and lower secondary education.

2 - The components referred to in the preceding paragraph are:

a) In lower primary education, an area of transdisciplinary nature, fostered by the generalist dimension of teaching in this level of education;

b) In upper primary and lower secondary education, annual or semi-annual subjects or with another organisation.

3 - In vocational courses and in upper secondary education the curriculum component Citizenship and Development is developed with the contribution of all the subjects comprised in the curriculum matrices.

Article 11

Curriculum reference documents

1 - The curriculum reference documents set out the intended learning to be developed by the students in the different disciplinary areas, subjects or short length units of training.

2– These documents are guidelines for the development of Core Curriculum Competences for each year of schooling, disciplinary area or subject as regards planning, implementation and assessment.

Section II Implementation

Article 12 Curriculum planning

1 - Curriculum planning aims at adapting and contextualising the curriculum to the school educational project as well as to the specificities of the classes and students.

2 - To comply with the provisions of article 6, the school's options regarding autonomy and curriculum flexibility aim at:

a) The consolidation, deepening and / or enrichment of the Core Curriculum Competences;

b) The development of the competences outlined in the references of the National Qualifications Catalogue, in the cases it applies to.

3- The school's options are comprised in the curriculum planning tools.

Article 13

Development of curriculum planning

1 - Considering the competence areas outlined in the Students' Profile by the End of Compulsory Schooling, each school sets out priorities and takes options within the development of curriculum planning aiming at:

- a) – The enhancement of arts, science, sport, humanities, ICT and practical and experimental work, as well as the embeddedness of regional and local components;
- b) The acquisition and development of multiple competences, such as research, assessment, reflection, critical and autonomous information mobilisation, aiming at solving problems and reinforcing students' self-esteem;
- c) Fostering communication and expression experiences in Portuguese and foreign languages in spoken, written, visual and multimodal modalities;
- d) Exercising active citizenship and social participation in contexts of sharing and collaboration and confronting ideas on current issues;
- e) Implementing project-based learning as a dynamic centred on the role of students as authors fostering deeper learning.

2 - The curriculum options of each school comprise, among others, the following possibilities:

- a) Partial or total combination of subjects;
- b) Alternation, throughout the school year, of periods of disciplinary practice with periods of multidisciplinary functioning, by means of collaborative work;
- c) Development of practical or experimental work splitting classes or using another organisation;
- d) Including projects developed at school in blocks within the weekly instruction time, in a rotating or other suitable way;
- e) Redistribution of the instruction time outlined for the different subjects in the curriculum matrices, fostering interdisciplinary working time and sharing instruction time between different subjects.
- f) Organisation of the subjects functioning on a quarterly or semiannual basis, or other organisation;
- g) Creating new subjects, spaces or working time for the development of components of local curriculum, among others, within an interdisciplinary approach.

3- In the accomplishment of what is written in sub-paragraph a) of the previous number, the existence of the subjects outlined in the curriculum matrices shall not be impaired.

4 - The domain of curriculum autonomy resulting from the partial or total combination of subjects is based on the curriculum reference documents of the subjects involved.

Article 14

Curriculum planning tools

1 - The curriculum planning at school and at class level complies with the educational project of each school and is a contextualised appropriation of the curriculum, fostering learning and the whole students' development.

2 - In addition to the educational project, which embodies the curriculum options, the curriculum class planning is also a tool for curriculum planning.

3- Schools may adopt other curriculum planning tools, such as curriculum plans for the year of schooling, to be managed by the educational team responsible for the intended core curriculum competences to be developed by the students in each year of schooling.

Article 15

School's Curriculum options

1 - Curriculum options, namely the criteria of organisation and pedagogical management, are inscribed in the educational project.

2 - The options referred to in the preceding paragraph are a reference in the work of planning, implementing and assessing teaching and learning, to be carried out at class level or within the year of schooling.

3 - In the curriculum planning to be developed by the school, the educational project also integrates, among other critical elements, the monitoring and evaluation procedures.

Article 16

Curriculum class planning

1 - The curriculum planning of a class is a dynamic document that translates the planning, implementation and assessment of teaching and learning, based on an interdisciplinary view of the curriculum.

2 – So as to meet the options included in the educational project, and considering the specific curriculum and the class profile, the curriculum planning of the class includes:

- a) The outlining of competence areas to prioritise while working with the class;
- b) The definition of the contribution of the various disciplinary areas, subjects and training units to the work of disciplinary integration, namely by defining the domains of autonomy of the curriculum and other forms of work organisation to be developed with the class;
- c) The selection of work methodologies to be used and the monitoring mechanisms of the evolution of student learning

3 - The teachers' class council can, based on pedagogical reasons, propose to the pedagogical council complementary curricular options to those inscribed in the school's educational project.

4 - In non-initial years (2, 3, 4, 6, 8, 9, 10, 12) the class council re-evaluates the options of the curriculum class planning already developed and makes the appropriate adjustments.

5 - The class curriculum plannings /plans are developed, in lower primary education, by the generalist teacher after previous discussions in the teachers' council, while in upper primary and lower secondary education it is developed after discussions in the teachers' class council.

6 - The provisions of paragraphs 1 to 4 of this article shall apply, with due adaptations, to the curricular planning tools to be adopted by the school, in line with the provisions of article 14, paragraph 3

7- The curriculum plans are submitted to the pedagogical council.

Article 17

Management of the class curriculum plan

In the work dynamics to be implemented, in the scope of the class curriculum plan, the class teacher, in liaison with the teaching council, and the class council, coordinated by the class director and / or course, should, as a rule, ensure:

- a) A work of an interdisciplinary and disciplinary nature;
- b) A preventive action, that allows to anticipate and to prevent failure and early school leave;
- c) The adequacy, diversity and complementarity of teaching and learning strategies, as well as the assessment tools and educational resources to be adopted in the class;
- d) Involvement of students in the planning, development and monitoring of the class curriculum plan;
- e) The regular practice of monitoring the class curriculum plan, evaluating, in accordance with its intentionality, the impact of the strategies and measures adopted;
- f) The production of descriptive information on student performance, promoting quality learning and self-regulation.

Article 18

Pedagogical practices

Aiming at an effective appropriation of knowledge, as well as the development of skills and attitudes by students, pedagogical practices should value, in particular:

- a) The management of the horizontal alignment of the curriculum implemented by the generalist teacher, by the class responsible and / or course or by another teacher;
- b) Explanation of the attained learning, expected performances and assessment tools, as references that constitute the specific learning profile of the students;
- c) Knowledge mobilisation regarding situations and problems of daily life or the environment;
- d) The organisation of teaching by providing activities for observation, experimentation and questioning of reality in an integrated way;
- e) The development of cooperative learning activities;
- (f) The critical use of information sources and the preference given to the use of information and communication technologies;
- g) The promotion of activities of students' civic intervention, privileging free initiative, autonomy and responsibility;
- h) The creation of stimulating environments and enhancers of the development of intellectual curiosity.
- i) The development of high level competences, focusing on research, analysis, synthesis, evaluation and communication activities.

Article 19

Measures to promote school achievement

1 - Within the framework of the strategic action plans and the multiannual improvement plans, schools adopt measures that aim at promoting school achievement, favouring, among others:

- a) The promotion of practices that anticipate and prevent school failure and early school leave, through a focus on pedagogical differentiation and early intervention rather than on remedial strategies;
- b) The involvement of students and parents in the definition, implementation, monitoring and evaluation of measures to promote educational achievement;

- c) The empowerment of schools' resources through programs that allow an intervention on the conditioning factors and predictors of educational achievement;
- d) Periodic assessment of their action plans, in their multiple dimensions, focusing on the impact assessment of locally defined strategies and identified as relevant for the promotion of school achievement;
- e) The collaborative work, valuing the exchange of knowledge and experiences, through practices of:
 - i) Coordination between teachers, various levels of education and various disciplinary areas;
 - ii) Temporary exchange between teachers of the same area or disciplinary domain.
- f) The organisation of students in working groups aiming at the:
 - i) Acquisition, development and consolidation of specific learning, with a view to promoting the alignment between disciplinary areas, functioning as a rule, on a temporary basis;
 - ii) Providing support to learning, based on a methodology of integration of several disciplinary areas, privileging the research, treatment and selection of information;
 - iii) Development of autonomous, peer-to-peer work with teacher mediation.
- g) The implementation of mentoring, aiming at the educational process guidance, namely through self-regulation of attained learning outcomes and the suitability to students' academic and social expectations;
- h) The promotion, through psychology and guidance services, of educational and vocational guidance actions, so that students may choose courses, areas and subjects that meet their vocational interests;
- i) The development of actions to support the students' growth and personal and social development, also aimed at promoting health and the prevention of risk behaviours.

2 - To the extent outlined in sub-paragraph i) of point e) of the previous number, and for lower primary education, the practices of support and coordination between teachers should focus on the areas of Artistic Education and Physical Education, mobilising teachers from other levels of education that belong to the recruitment groups within these areas.

Section III

Assessment of learning

Article 20

Goals

1 - Assessment, being a key element of curriculum development, is a process that regulates teaching and learning, which guides the students' educational pathway and certifies the developed learning, namely the acquired knowledge, as well as the skills and attitudes developed in the scope of the competence areas outlined in the Students' Profile by the End of Compulsory Schooling.

2 – Assessment aims essentially at the improvement of teaching and learning based on a continuous process of pedagogical intervention.

3 - Assessment, as part of the curriculum, demands that the techniques, tools and procedures be diversified and adapted to the purposes, the assessment target, the recipients and the type of information to be collected.

4 - The different ways of collecting information about learning, either within the context of internal assessment, which is teachers' responsibility, as well as the school pedagogical management bodies or other legally authorised entities' responsibility, or within the context of external assessment, which is the responsibility of the services or bodies of the Ministry of Education, aim to achieve, in compliance with their aims, the following objectives:

a) Informing and sustaining pedagogical interventions, adjusting strategies that lead to the improvement of the quality of learning, aiming at promoting school success;

b) Verifying the pursuit of the objectives defined in the curriculum;

c) Certifying learning.

5 - Without prejudice to the specificities that distinguish the internal and external assessment processes of learning, in terms of student performance and curriculum development, the analysis of the data collected should value approaches of complementarity, in order to enhance the quality improvement teaching and learning.

Article 21

Assessment of learning

1 - The internal assessment of learning:

a) It comprises the following modalities of evaluation:

i) Diagnosis;

ii) Formative;

iii) Summative

b) It mobilises various and adequate techniques, tools and procedures.

2 - The external assessment of learning:

(a) generates information to be used for:

i) Diagnostic;

ii) Formative;

iii) Summative.

b) Understanding:

(i) Benchmark tests;

ii) Final tests of lower secondary education;

(iii) National final examinations

Article 22

Internal assessment of learning

1 - Diagnostic assessment is carried out whenever it is considered appropriate, being critical to support the definition of strategies of pedagogical differentiation, to overcome possible students' difficulties, to enable their school integration and to support the school and vocational guidance.

2 - Formative assessment is continuous and systematic, and it must draw upon a variety of information-gathering tools that are appropriate to the diversity of learning, to the recipients and to the circumstances in which they occur, allowing teachers, students, caregivers and other legally authorised actors or entities to obtain information on the development of teaching and learning, in order to adjust processes and strategies.

3 - Summative assessment comprises a global judgment about the learning attained by the students, having as goals the marking and certification.

4 - Formative assessment, defined in no. 2, is the main assessment modality and allows to obtain privileged and systematic information within the different curriculum domains, and should be the basis for the learning support, namely to self-regulation within the students' school pathways, aligned with provided information for the parents.

Article 23

External assessment of learning

1- External assessment has as reference the Core Curriculum Competences, as outlined in no. 2 of article 11, while common reference document.

2 - The tests and examinations carried out in the scope of the external assessment should also comprise the assessment of knowledge mobilisation skills, with special focus on the competence areas outlined in the Students' Profile by the End of Compulsory Schooling.

3 - Benchmark tests, which are universal and compulsory, are carried out at the end of grades 2, 5 and 8 and they enable:

a) To monitor the development of the curriculum, in the different areas, providing regular information to the education system;

(b) to provide detailed information on pupils' performance in school, teachers, guardians and pupils themselves;

c) To promote a timely pedagogical intervention, directed to the difficulties identified for each student.

4 - The assessment of primary and lower secondary students as well of those attending specialised artistic courses implies the accomplishment of final tests by the end of grade 9 (lower secondary).

5 - The assessment of upper secondary students attending mainstream courses implies national final examinations, to be carried out in the terminal year of the subject, in the following terms:

a) Portuguese, within the general component;

b) Triennial subject within the specific component;

c) Two biennial subjects within the specific component, according to the student's own training course, or a biennial subject within the specific component of the course attended and Philosophy.

6 - The final examinations and the final national examinations are intended to assess the performance of students and certify the accomplishment of lower secondary and upper secondary education within the offers provided for in paragraphs 4 and 5, in compliance with the specific regulations.

Article 24

Access to final examinations and final national examinations

Access to final examinations of lower secondary education and final national examinations of upper secondary education is guaranteed for students attending offers that do not provide for external assessment, for the purpose of pursuing further studies within different school pathways, in compliance with the provisions of the external assessment tests and whole school tests to assess the attendance of primary and secondary education.

Article 25

Actors in the assessment process

1 - In the assessment of learning, all the actors with competence have an important role in the process, namely teachers, trainers and members of juries. Those who hold critical responsibility are the generalist teacher in lower primary education, and upper primary and secondary education teachers.

2. School shall ensure the informed participation of students and parents and guardians in the learning assessment process by systematically promoting the sharing of information, involvement and accountability of the various actors.

Article 26

Assessment effects

1 - The diagnostic assessment enables the students' school integration, it supports the definition of teaching strategies as well as school and vocational guidance.

2 - Formative assessment generates pedagogical measures suitable to the students' characteristics and to the quality learning to be developed and makes use of mechanisms of detailed information on students' performance.

3. Without prejudice to the provisions of paragraph 5, summative assessment shall be carried out at the end of each school year and shall give rise to a decision at the end of the school year:

(a) in primary and lower secondary education and in specialised artistic courses on the transition and approval of the completion of those levels of education or the reguidance of the students' school pathway, as well as on the progression in the subjects within the artistic training component;

b) In the mainstream courses and in the specialised artistic courses of upper secondary education, on the approval in each subject, the progression in the non-terminal subjects, the transition to the subsequent year of schooling or the reguidance of the students' school pathway and the accomplishment of upper secondary education.

4 - Summative evaluation, in vocational courses (upper primary and secondary education), enables a decision on the approval in each subject, module or training unit, the progression or reguidance of students' school pathway, and the accomplishment of the corresponding level of education.

5 – Whenever schools adopt a non-yearly organisation of study programs, summative assessment shall be carried out in compliance with the rules set out in the legislation in force for the assessment in primary and secondary education.

Article 27

Assessment scale

1 - Information resulting from the summative assessment presents itself as follows:

- a) As regards lower primary education, in the attribution of a qualitative statement along with a descriptive assessment in all disciplinary areas
- b) As for upper primary and lower secondary education, there is a scale from 1 to 5 in all subjects and training units.
- c) As regards upper secondary education, there is a 1-20 scale for all the subjects and training units.

2 - The options of each school that result in the creation of new subjects are to be legislated by what has been stated in the previous number.

3 - The materialisation of the summative assessment within the subject Citizenship and Development, as regards upper secondary education, is carried out, according to paragraph c) of no. 1, on proposal of the class responsible teacher, after hearing the other teachers.

Article 28

Transition and retention

1 - The evolution of students' school pathway in primary and lower secondary education assumes a logic of level of education, progressing to the next level every student who has developed the intended learning for each level of education.

2 - If the student does not develop the intended learning for a non-terminal year of the level of education that is critical for the development of the intended learning of the subsequent year, the lower primary teacher, after hearing the board of teachers, or the class council, in the upper primary and lower secondary education, may, exceptionally, determine the student's retention in the same year of schooling.

3 - The provision in the previous number does not apply to the 1st year of schooling.

4 – In case of retention, the curriculum plan for the class in which the student is to be integrated in the subsequent year of schooling shall provide for teaching and learning strategies and educational resources suitable for the full development of learning.

5 - Whenever the student of mainstream courses and specialised artistic courses does not have transition conditions, the curriculum plan for the class in which the student will be integrated in the subsequent school year follows what has been stated in the previous number.

6 - The subject Religious Studies is not considered for the purpose of student progression.

Article 29

Approval and conclusion

1 - The completion of lower secondary education and specialised artistic courses in upper primary and lower secondary education depends on the completion, on a compulsory basis, of final examinations for subjects under external assessment.

2 - The completion of upper secondary education still depends on:

a) As regards mainstream courses - national final examinations of subjects under external assessment;

b) As regards specialised artistic courses - approval in the test of artistic aptitude and, according to the artistic area, in the technical training component;

c) In vocational courses, passing the vocational aptitude test, final test and the technical training component;

Table I

(in reference to articles 5 e 7)

Primary and lower secondary education

Lower primary (a)

Curriculum components	Weekly instruction time (b)	
	Years 1 and 2	Years 3 and 4
Portuguese	7 hours	7 hours
Maths	7 hours	7 hours
Science, History, geography	3 hours	3 hours s
Educação Artística e Educação Física	5 hours	5 hours
Monitores Study (c)/Complementary offer (d)	3 hours	1 hours
English	--	2 hours
Citizenship and development	(e)	(e)
Total (f)	25 hours	25 hours
Religious/Moral Studies (g)	1 hour	1 hour

- (a) During the four years of schooling, this compulsory provision of Optional Curricular Enrichment Activities (AEC), with a weekly instruction time of five hours, to be developed in compliance with sub-paragraph (k) of n Article 4 (2)
- (b) The weekly instruction time indicated is a reference for each component of the curriculum.
- (c) In compliance with Article 19 (1) (f) (ii)
- (d) In compliance with Article 6 (3)
- (e) In compliance with Article 10 (2) (a)
- (f) It includes the time spent in breaks between activities, except for the lunch period.
- (g) Optional attendance subject

Table II

(in reference to articles 5 e 7)
Primary and lower secondary education

Upper primary education

Within their autonomy, schools organise the school days in the unit that they consider most convenient and according to their options regarding autonomy and curriculum flexibility.

Curriculum components	Weekly instruction Time (a)		
	Year 5	Year 6	Total within level of education
Disciplinary areas:			
Languages and Social Studies Portuguese English Portuguese History e Geography Citizenship and Development (b)	525	525	1050
Maths and Science Maths Science	350	350	700
Artistic and Technological education Visual Arts Technologies Musical Education ITC (b)	325	325	650
Physical Education	150	150	300
Religious/Moral Studies (c)	(45)	(45)	(90)
Total	(1350) (1395) (d)	(1350) (1395) (d)	(2700)
Complementary offer.....			

Monitored Study (e).....	200	200	400
-----------------------------	-----	-----	-----

- a. The weekly instruction time indicated is a reference for each component of the curriculum.
- b. In compliance with Article 10 (2) (b)
- c. Optional attendance subject.
- d. In compliance with Article 4 (2) (f), Article 6 (3) and Article 7 (2) Optional, but mandatory attendance when the offer is provided by the school.
- e. In compliance with Article 19 (1) (f) (ii) Mandatory and optional attendance component.

Table III

(in reference to articles 5 e 7)

Primary and lower secondary education— Specialised artistic courses

Upper primary education

Within their autonomy, schools organise the school days in the unit that they consider most convenient and according to their options regarding autonomy and curriculum flexibility.

Componentes do currículo /Disciplinas	Carga horária semanal (a)		
	5.º ano	6.º ano	Total de ciclo
Áreas disciplinares:			
Línguas e Estudos Sociais	550	550	1100
Português			
Inglês			
História e Geografia de Portugal			
Cidadania e Desenvolvimento (b)			
Matemática e Ciências	350	350	700
Matemática			
Ciências Naturais			
Educação Visual	90	90	180
Educação Física (c)	135	135	270
Formação Artística Especializada	315 a 630	315 a 630	630 a 1260
Educação Moral e Religiosa (d)	(45)	(45)	(90)
(e).....	45 (e)	45 (e)	90 (e)
Total (f)	1485 a 1710 (1530 a 1755)	1485 a 1710 (1530 a 1755)	2970 a 3420 (3060) a 3510)
Oferta Complementar	(g)	(g)	

- (a) The weekly instruction time indicated is a reference for each component of the curriculum, except for the specialised artistic training component.
- (b) In compliance with Article 10 (2) (b)

- (c) Inexistent in dance training.
- (d) Optional attendance subject.
- (e) Optional instruction time offer, to be used, fully or partially, in the component of artistic training specialised in joint activities or in the reinforcement of collective subjects.
- (f) The sum of the hours allocated to each course results in a total time less than the Total in the matrix, leaving the school to manage the remaining time, to be used in reinforcing the components of the curriculum, except for the specialised artistic training component.
- (g) In compliance with Article 4 (2) (f), Article 6 (3) and Article 7 (2) Optional, but mandatory attendance when the offer is provided by the school.

Table IV

(in reference to articles 5 e 7)

Primary and lower secondary education

Lower secondary education

Within their autonomy, schools organise the school days in the unit that they consider most convenient and according to their options regarding autonomy and curriculum flexibility.

Componentes do currículo	Carga horária semanal (a)			
	7.º ano	8.º ano	9.º ano	Total de ciclo
Áreas disciplinares:				
Português	200	200	200	600
Línguas Estrangeiras:.....	250	250	250	750
Inglês				
Língua Estrangeira II				
Ciências Sociais e Humanas.....	275	225	225	725
História				
Geografia				
Cidadania e Desenvolvimento (b)				
Matemática	200	200	200	600
Ciências Físico-Naturais.....	250	300	300	850
Ciências Naturais				
Físico-Química				
Educação Artística e Tecnológica	175	175	125	475
Educação Visual				
TIC (b)				
Educação Física	150	150	200	500
Educação Moral e Religiosa (c).....	(45)	(45)	(45)	(135)
Total	1500 (1545)	1500 (1545)	1500 (1545)	4500 (4635)
Oferta Complementar	(d)	(d)	(d)	

- (a) The weekly instruction time indicated is a reference for each component of the curriculum.
- (b) In compliance with Article 10 (2) (b)
- (c) Optional attendance subject.
- (d) In compliance with Article 4 (2) (f), Article 6 (3) and Article 7 (2) Optional, but mandatory attendance when the offer is provided by the school.

Table V

(in reference to articles 5 e 7)

Primary and lower secondary education

Lower secondary education— Specialised artistic courses

Within their autonomy, schools organise the school days in the unit that they consider most convenient and according to their options regarding autonomy and curriculum flexibility.

Componentes do currículo	Carga horária semanal (a)			
	7.º ano	8.º ano	9.º ano	Total de ciclo
Áreas disciplinares:				
Português	200	200	200	600
Línguas Estrangeiras:.....	225	225	225	675
Inglês				
Língua Estrangeira II				
Ciências Sociais e Humanas	250	250	275	775
História				
Geografia				
Cidadania e Desenvolvimento (b)				
Matemática	200	200	200	600
Ciências Físico-Naturais:.....	225	225	225	675
Ciências Naturais				
Físico-Química				
Educação Visual (c)	90 (c)	90 (c)	90 (c)	270
Educação Física (d).....	135	135	135	405
Formação Artística Especializada	315 a 720	315 a 810	315 a 990	945 a 2520
Educação Moral e Religiosa (e).....	(45)	(45)	(45)	(135)
(f).....	45 (f)	45 (f)	45 (f)	135
Total (g)	1575 a 1980 (1620 a 2025)	1575 a 2070 (1620 a 2115)	1575 a 2250 (1620 a 2295)	4725 a 6300 (4860 a 6435)
Oferta Complementar	(h)	(h)	(h)	

(a) The weekly instruction time indicated is a reference for each component of the curriculum, except for the specialised artistic training component.

(b) In compliance with Article 10 (2) (b)

(c) Optional attendance subject, within a parent's decision — in compliance with the school's possibilities — at the moment of the enrolment in lower secondary education regulated by the current document.

(d) Inexistent in dance training.

- (e) Optional attendance subject
- (f) Optional instruction time offer, to be used, fully or partially, in the component of artistic training specialised in joint activities or in the reinforcement of collective subjects.
- (g) (g) The sum of the hours allocated to each course results in a total time which is less than the total shown in the matrix, leaving the school to manage the remaining time, to be used in reinforcing the components of the curriculum, except for the specialised artistic training component.
- (h) In compliance with Article 4 (2) (f), Article 6 (3) and Article 7 (2) Optional, but mandatory attendance when the offer is provided by the school.

Table VI

(in reference to articles 5 e 7)

Primary and lower secondary education- Vocational courses

Within their autonomy, schools organise the school days in the unit that they consider most convenient and according to their options regarding autonomy and curriculum flexibility.

Componentes de formação/Disciplinas		Carga horária Ciclo de formação (horas)					
		Tipo 1 (a)		Tipo 2 (b)	Tipo 3 (c)		
		Tipo 1 (b)	Tipo 1 (c)				
Sociocultural:		Cidadania e Desenvolvimento (g)					
Língua Portuguesa			288	90	192	45	
Língua Estrangeira.....			96	45	192	45	
Cidadania e Mundo Atual.....			192	90	192	21	
Tecnologias de Informação e Comunicação...			96	45	96	21	
Higiene, Saúde e Segurança de Trabalho.....			30	30	30	30	
Educação Física.....			192	45	96	30	
Subtotal				894	345	798	192
Científica:							
Matemática Aplicada.....			288 (d)	90 (d)	333 (d)	66 (d)	
Disciplina/domínio específica(o).....							
Subtotal			288	90	333	66	
Tecnológica:							
Unidade(s) do itinerário de qualificação associado (e).....		480	480	768	732		
Prática:							
Formação em contexto de trabalho (f).....		210	210	210	210		
Total			1872	1125	2109	1200	

(a) Typology subdivided into two pathways: (i) two-year (1872 hours) training cycle for lower primary students (ii) one-year (1125 hours) training cycle for students with the completion of lower primary education.

(b) Global instruction time not limited by the two years of the training cycle, to be managed by the training entity within the framework of its specific competences, ensuring the balance within the yearly instruction time in order to optimise both the in school training and on-job training.

(c) Global instruction time planned for a one-year training, to be managed by the school within the framework of its specific competences ensuring the balance within the instruction time in order to optimise both the in school training and on-job training.

(d) Instruction time to be distributed between the subject / area of Applied Mathematics (Matemática Aplicada) and specific subject / domain (o).

(e) Training units with a technological, technical and practical nature within the technological training component of the training references outlined in the National Qualifications Catalogue.

(f) On-job training aims at acquiring and developing technical, relational and organisational competences critical to the professional qualification to be acquired.

(g) In compliance with Article 10 (3)

Table VII

(in reference to articles 5 e 7)

Upper secondary education — Mainstream courses

Within their autonomy, schools organise the school days in the unit that they consider most convenient and according to their options regarding autonomy and curriculum flexibility.

Componentes de formação/Disciplinas		Carga horária semanal (a)		
		10.º ano	11.º ano	12.º ano
Geral:	Cidadania e Desenvolvimento (j)			
Português		180	180	200
Língua Estrangeira I, II ou III (b).....		150	150	-
Filosofia		150	150	-
Educação Física		150	150	150
Específica:				
Trienal		250	250	270
Opções (c):				
Bienal 1		270 ou 315	270 ou 315	--
Bienal 2.....		270 ou 315	270 ou 315	--
Opções (d):				
Anual 1		--	--	150
Opções (e):				
Anual 2 (f).....	--	--	150	
Educação Moral e Religiosa (g).....		90	90	90
Total (h) (i)		1530 a 1620 (1620 a 1710)	1530 a 1620 (1620 a 1710)	1035 (1125)

(a) The weekly instruction time indicated is a reference for each component of the curriculum.

(b) The student chooses a foreign language. If he has studied only one foreign language in primary and lower secondary education, he will be required to start a second language in upper secondary education. In case the student starts a language, taking into account the

school's offer, he can cumulatively continue Foreign Language I as an optional subject, under expressed acceptance of the increase in the instruction time.

(c) The student chooses two biannual subjects.

(d) and (e) The student chooses two annual subjects, one of which must be within the set of options in point d).

(e) Offer provided in compliance with the school's educational project - set of subject common to all courses.

(f) Optional attendance subject, with a fixed instruction time of 90 minutes.

(g) Depending on the options of the various mainstream courses.

(h) The sum of the hours allocated to each course results in a total time less than the total constant in the matrix, leaving the school to manage the remaining time.

(i) In compliance with Article 10 (3).

Table VIII

(in reference to articles 5 e 7)

Upper secondary education - Specialised artistic courses

Within their autonomy, schools organise the school days in the unit that they consider most convenient and according to their options regarding autonomy and curriculum flexibility.

Componentes de formação/Disciplinas		Carga horária semanal (a)					
		10.º ano	11.º ano	12.º ano			
Geral:		Cidadania e Desenvolvimento (i)					
Português					180	180	200
Língua Estrangeira I, II ou III (b).....					150	150	-
Filosofia					150	150	-
Educação Física (c)					150	150	150
Científica:							
Duas a quatro disciplinas (d)							
Subtotal (e)					180 a 540	225 a 630	225 a 630
Técnica Artística:							
Duas a cinco disciplinas (d)							
Subtotal (e)					225 a 1080 (d)	270 a 1080	180 (d) a 1260
Educação Moral e Religiosa (f).....		(90)	(90)	(90)			
Total (e) (g)		1305 a 2070 (d) (1395 a 2160 (d))	1350 a 2250 (1440 a 2340)	945 (d) a 2160 (h)(1035 (d) a 2250)			

(a) The weekly instruction time indicated is a reference for each component of the curriculum.

(b) The student chooses a foreign language. If he has studied only one foreign language in primary and lower secondary education, he will be required to start a second language in upper secondary education. In case the student starts a language, taking into account the school's offer, he can cumulatively continue Foreign Language I as an optional subject, under expressed acceptance of the increase in the instruction time.

(c) Inexistent in dance training.

(d) It comprises a biannual subject, to be attended either in years 10 and 11, or in years 11 and 12, chosen from a range of options to be defined according to the course nature and the school's educational project, being able to integrate, according to its nature, the specific scientific component or technical artistic component.

(e) Possible timeframe for allocation of instruction time according to the curriculum of each course.

(f) Mandatory subject, with a fixed weekly instruction time of 2 x 45 minutes.

(g) The sum of the hours allocated to each course results in a total time less than the total constant in the matrix, leaving the school to manage the remaining time, to be used as a reinforcement of the general training component.

(h) It can comprise, according to the artistic area, on-job training.

(i) In compliance with Article 10 (3)

Table IX

(in reference to articles 5 e 7)

Upper secondary education – Vocational courses

Within their autonomy, schools organise the school days in the unit that they consider most convenient and according to their options regarding autonomy and curriculum flexibility.

Componentes de formação/ Disciplinas		Carga horária Ciclo de formação (horas) (a)
Sociocultural:	Português	320
	Língua Estrangeira I, II ou III (b).....	220
	Área de Integração	220
	Tecnologias de Informação e Comunicação.....	100
	Educação Física	140
Subtotal		1000
Científica:	Duas a três disciplinas (c).....	500
Tecnológica:	Três a quatro disciplinas (d).....	1000 a 1300
	Formação em contexto de trabalho (e).....	600 a 840
Total (f)		3100 a 3440

(a) Global instruction time not limited by the three years of the training cycle, to be managed by the school within its pedagogic autonomy, ensuring the balance within the yearly instruction time in order to optimise module managing, on-job training and flexibility projects.

(b). The student chooses a foreign language. If he has studied only one foreign language in primary and lower secondary education, he will be required to start a second language in upper secondary education.

(c) Core scientific subjects to be set in the training references of the National Qualifications Catalogue, depending on the professional qualifications to be acquired.

(d) Short-term training units developed in compliance with training guidelines in the National Qualifications Catalogue, observing the guidelines of the National Agency for Qualification and Vocational Education, I.P., particularly in the transitional courses.

(e) In compliance with Article 8 (5)

(f) The total instruction time for the vocational course may vary from a minimum of 3100 hours to a maximum of 3440 hours. In order not to exceed the maximum instruction time for the whole course, the instruction time in on-job training must be adjusted according to the hours for the subjects within the technological component.

(g) In compliance with Article 10 (3)

Table X

(in reference to articles 5 e 7)

Upper secondary education – Vocational courses

Within their autonomy, schools organise the school days in the unit that they consider most convenient and according to their options regarding autonomy and curriculum flexibility.

		Carga horária Ciclo de formação (horas)					
		Tipo 4 (a)	Curso de Formação Complementar	Tipo 5	Tipo 6	Tipo 7	
Componentes de formação/Disciplinas							
Sociocultural:		Cidadania e Desenvolvimento (g)					
Português			45	90	192	45	--
Língua Estrangeira.....			45	90	96	--	--
Cidadania e Sociedade.....			21	45	21	30	30
Tecnologias de Informação e Comunicação...			21	45	21	--	--
Higiene, Saúde e Segurança de Trabalho.....			30	30	30	30	30
Educação Física.....			30	90	90	45	45
Subtotal			192	390	450	150	105
Científica:							
Disciplina/domínio científico 1 (b).....					192	90	
Disciplina/domínio científico 2 (b).....			90 (c)	180 (c)	96	90	
Disciplina/domínio científico 3 (b).....			--		96	--	
Subtotal			90	180	384	180	
Tecnológica:							
Unidade(s) do itinerário de qualificação associado (d).....			738	--	1232	840	840
Unidade(s) de Formação Complementar (e)....			--	240	--	--	--
Prática:			/				
Formação em contexto de trabalho (f).....			210	210	210	210	210
Total		1230	1020	2276	1380	1155	

(a) Global instruction time for a one-year training course, to be managed by the school within the framework of its specific competences, ensuring the balance within the yearly instruction time in order to optimise both the in school training and on-job training.

(b) Subjects within the scientific training component for the intended professional qualification.

(c) To be distributed among the subjects / fields of scientific training component.

(d) Training units of a technological, technical and practical nature within the technological training component of the references outlined in the National Qualifications Catalogue.

(e) Training units / domains of complementary technological, technical and practical nature.

(f) On-job training aims at acquiring and developing technical, relational and organisational competences relevant to the professional qualification to be acquired or, in the case of the Complementary Training Course, acquired in complementary technological training units.

(g) In compliance with Article 10 (3)